

1. CORS Chat

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-15T14:49:54+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/15/cors-chat/>

Tool: CORS Chat I built this today (with GPT-5.6-Sol xhigh) to help test Qwen 3.8 27B running in LM Studio on both my M5 MacBook Pro and an NVIDIA DGX Spark. It provides a web UI for exercising an OpenAI-Responses-compatible chat endpoint. I've tried it against LM Studio with the --cors option and OpenRouter, and both work fine. Conversations are persisted in the browser and can be exported as copy-pasted JSON. One fun detail is that it notices SVG images that are being generated and progressively renders them in the chat while the tokens are still streaming in. Tags: svg , ai , generative-ai , llms , cors , openrouter , lm-studio

2. Northern Gannet

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-15T03:22:00+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/15/sighting-391300422/>

Northern Gannet, in Pillar Point Harbor, CA, US This is Morris. Morris is a local celebrity: the only known Northern Gannet (Morus bassanus) in the entire Pacific Ocean. They showed up in the Farallon Islands off the coast of San Francisco 14 years ago . They have since made Pillar Point harbor their home, where they are quite easy to spot: the only white bird with a yellow head, usually hanging out with the smaller black Brandt's cormorants near the harbor sign visible from the end of the commercial pier. Tags: photography , wildlife , half-moon-bay

3. Stealing Reasoning Traces from Proprietary LLM APIs

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-11T22:40:45+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/11/stealing-reasoning-traces/>

Stealing Reasoning Traces from Proprietary LLM APIs A vanity domain name (stolen-thoughts.com) for a neat paper : Anthropic, OpenAI, and Google return encrypted chain-of-thought blocks to clients that can be replayed across sessions, users, and models. We take a trace produced by a frontier model, replay it into a weaker sibling, jailbreak the weaker model, and recover the stronger model's hidden reasoning in plaintext You can see an example of these encrypted blocks by running: `curl https://api.openai.com/v1/responses \-H " Content-Type: application/json " \-H " Authorization: Bearer $(llm keys get openai) " \-d ' { "model": "gpt-5.6-luna", "input": "Solve step by step: What is the smallest positive integer divisible by every integer from 1 through 20?", "reasoning": { "effort": "medium" }, "include": ["reasoning.encrypted_content"], "store": false, "stream": false } ' Here's the full output , which includes chunks that look like this: "output": [{ "id": "rs_0a7479de7ebae170016a7ba1a0334c8198a95590217efe343c", "type": "reasoning", "content": [], "encrypted_content": "gAAAAABqe6GjepE1wDjbFCZg0BHB6ucGnN0jvzqygG... The paper's authors found that every model under the same fa...`

4. Drata

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-15T21:40:15Z

Link: <https://drata.com/daring>

My thanks to Drata for sponsoring last week at DF. Their message is short and sweet: Leverage autonomous AI agents to automate compliance, manage internal and third-party risk, and continuously prove your security posture. ?

5. Amazon Is Spiting Customers With Unhelpful Order Confirmation Emails

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-12T18:51:01Z

Link: <https://www.theverge.com/ai-artificial-intelligence/977733/amazon-order-emails-google-gmail-ai-agents-data>

Mia Sato, The Verge: Earlier this summer, Amazon customers began noticing that emails related to their online orders looked sparse: Order confirmation emails didn't name specific items

anymore, and instead listed only item categories. ?Your Beauty item is confirmed!? an email about my retainer cleaning tablets read. Shoppers have posted other iterations of the redacted emails as well: ? Ordered: 1 Hardware item ,? ? Your Drugstore, Shoes, and other items are here! ? and ? 1 Nutrition & Wellness, 1 Wireless Accessories ,? for example. The emails have clip art-style illustrations of general product categories, and a shopper has to exit their email and go to Amazon to see what item it?s actually referring to. Complaints about the vague emails appear to have started in July; orders placed as recently as June contain thumbnails and names of the exact item purchased. [...] ?As customers shop with us more frequently, including on their phones, and use the ?Your Orders? page in the Amazon app to get real-time, consolidated order details and delivery status, we?ve simplified several order-related emails to direct customers to our app and website for the latest information on their orders,?...

6. App Store Scam of the Week: ?TabControl Extension? for Safari

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-12T15:06:05Z

Link: <https://lapcatsoftware.com/articles/2026/8/4.html>

Jeff Johnson: These purported reviews, all but one of which is 5 stars, are all in English. Yet none of them is in the US App Store. I also looked at other English-speaking countries such as Australia and Canada but found no reviews. Also suspicious is that the name of every reviewer was a first name followed by an initial for the last name. If you?ve ever looked through App Store user reviews, it?s unusual to find this naming format. In most cases, the name on App Store user reviews is a uniquely chosen username, with no space character, often suffixed by a number. The final and most conclusive evidence that these reviews are fake, totally invented out of thin air by the developer (or more likely, by an LLM), is that the dates on the reviews, such as ?Mar 12,? predate the release of TabControl Extension in the App Store! God only knows what this obvious AI slop scam is doing with the data from users? Safari tabs. It?s currently the 12th or 13th most popular Safari extension in the App Store. ?

7. Probability of correcting errors

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sat, 15 Aug 2026 16:33:56 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/15/probability-of-correcting-errors/>

Error correcting codes are most simply described in terms of the errors they can certainly correct. For example, the Hadamard code used for the Mariner 9 probe to Mars encoded each 6-bit pixel to a 32-bit codeword in such a way that the original pixel could be recovered if no more than 7 bits were [?] The post Probability of correcting errors first appeared on John D. Cook .

8. Compressing a Hadamard matrix

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sat, 15 Aug 2026 15:40:43 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/15/compressing-a-hadamard-matrix/>

Hadamard matrices are in the news following the recent announcement of a newly discovered Hadamard matrix. I?ve written three posts on Hadamard matrices recently, one as a sort of introduction and two on applications: the error correcting code used in the Mariner 9 probe and constructing sphere packings. A Hadamard matrix is an orthogonal matrix [?] The post Compressing a Hadamard matrix first appeared on John D. Cook .

9. Book Review: Slags by Emma Jane Unsworth ?????

Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Sat, 15 Aug 2026 11:34:42 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/book-review-slags-by-emma-jane-unsworth/>

I?m really not sure what to make of this book. It was recommended by my book club as something between tragedy and comedy. The characters are excruciatingly well written - if you (or your friends) shoplifted Impulse body-spray back in the 1990s, you?ll be hit by a terrifying wave of nostalgia. It reminds me of this excellent essay by Marie Le Conte about consent. What can a teenage girl?

10. Edinburgh Fringe: Hot Flush ? A Bold, We?re Old(ish) Burlesque Show ?????

Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Thu, 13 Aug 2026 16:45:02 +0000

Link:

<https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/edinburgh-fringe-hot-flush-a-bold-were-oldish-burlesque-show/>
Are menopausal women hot? It is often said that pornographic actresses move straight from "barely legal" to "MILF" without so much as moment in between. Unlike the fringe's other burlesque shows - which seem to exclusively feature nymphettes and twink with nary a grey hair between them - Hot Flush focuses on the over 40s. Look, you probably don't want to read a review of how tempting I found?

11. Edinburgh Fringe - Eleanor Morton: The Mermaid ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Thu, 13 Aug 2026 14:55:59 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/edinburgh-fringe-eleanor-morton-the-mermaid/>

The undisputed queen of short-form viral video comedy snacks takes to the stage. Well, swims to the stage. The Mermaid is a delightful and gentle amble through the confusing world of a girl who just wants to become a mermaid. Less standup and more storytelling, nevertheless it packs in the laughs with some rather clever jokes, a bit of bawdy humour, and - a rarity on The Fringe - a decently?

12. Site update: a few posts have been removed

Source: Xe Iaso's blog | Published: Sat, 15 Aug 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://xeiaso.net/notes/2026/blogposts-removed/>

TL;DR: hospital drugs are some shit, man

13. This Week in Package Management: 15 August 2026

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-08-15T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/08/15/this-week-in-package-management.html>

Week thirteen of the roundup, built from the package manager OPML feed collection and whatever I've posted or boosted on Mastodon . Releases pnpm 12, the Rust rewrite, reached RC 5 and the project published What's different in pnpm 12 : commands, flags, settings and the lockfile format are unchanged from pnpm 11, so upgrading is not a migration. RC 5 breaks dependency cycles canonically during peer resolution by ordering cycle members by package id and always cutting the closing edge in the same place, so the same dependencies produce the same lockfile regardless of importer or resolution order. Hatch 1.18.0 adds a sources environment option that redirects individual dependencies to a local path, Git repository, URL, alternate index or workspace member at install time without altering the published metadata, and hatch build --all to build every workspace member at once. Hatchling 1.32.0 lets the version command set a version that is statically defined in project.version , rewriting pyproject.toml in place. Renovate 44.24.0?44.30.3 adds support for GitHub's Actions lockfile, relocking it alongside uses: reference updates. 44.28.0 adds a gomodTidyAll option to run go mod tidy across...

14. Reading List ? 08/15/2026

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Sat, 15 Aug 2026 12:02:38 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/reading-list-08152026>

Home price declines, the Strategic Petroleum Reserve, The Boring Company fundraising, and more.

15. Concurrent Servers: Part 7 - Rust

Source: Eli Bendersky's website | Published: 2026-08-15T09:41:00-07:00

Link: <https://eli.thegreenplace.net/2026/concurrent-servers-part-7-rust/>

This is part 7 in a series of posts on writing concurrent network servers. In this part, we discuss how the challenges described in earlier parts are tackled in the Rust programming language. All posts in the series: Part 1 - Introduction Part 2 - Threads Part 3 - Event-driven Part 4 - libuv ?

16. Training a Reinforcement Learning Model to Play Bonk.io

Source: Cats with power tools | Published: Sat, 15 Aug 2026 02:50:29 GMT

Link: <https://blog.pixelmelt.dev/training-a-reinforcement-learning-model-to-play-bonk-io/>

Dissecting a web game to re implement the physics engine and train a neural network on it.